



ONE-SHEET: DIVINE DECEPTION NOIR

They called her back for a funeral. She stayed for the reckoning.

Format: Lifetime Original Movie

Genre: Southern Gothic Thriller / Noir

Tone: Eve's Bayou meets Greenleaf meets Double Jeopardy

Runtime: Approx. 90–95 minutes

Target Audience: Women 25–54, BIPOC viewers, fans of **Secrets of a Marine's Wife**, **The Clark Sisters**, and **The Stranger She Knew**

THE HOOK

When gospel superstar Harmony Wells returns to her Georgia hometown for her grandmother's funeral, she uncovers a web of lies, laundered money, and generational abuse hidden beneath her church's holy facade. The deeper she digs, the closer she comes to discovering that the man she's feared her whole life, the town's beloved pastor, is not only a criminal, but her biological father and her mother's rapist.

CASTING IDEAS

HARMONY WELLS – Gospel star with a haunted past, brave but wounded

- Tier 1: Keke Palmer, Chloe Bailey, Dominique Fishback
 - Tier 2: Ryan Destiny, Lex Scott Davis, Imani Lewis
 - Wildcard: Sierra McClain (if music performance is key)
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FAITH CROSS – Pastor’s conflicted daughter, holding secrets and guilt

- Tier 1: Teyonah Parris, Meagan Good
 - Tier 2: Chantel Riley, Ebony Obsidian, Jasmine Cephas Jones
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PASTOR JONATHAN CROSS – Charismatic and controlling, a serpent in silk

- Tier 1: Courtney B. Vance, Giancarlo Esposito, Blair Underwood
 - Tier 2: Russell Hornsby, Elvis Nolasco, Mykelti Williamson
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BLESSED WELLS – Harmony’s mother; devout, damaged, and silently complicit

- Tier 1: Angela Bassett, Lynn Whitfield
 - Tier 2: Tina Lifford, Vanessa Bell Calloway, Adina Porter
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AGENT PATRICIA VANCE – FBI agent with ambiguous motives

- Tier 1: Regina King, Nia Long
 - Tier 2: Erika Alexander, Judy Reyes, Anika Noni Rose
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THEMES

- Institutional betrayal & religious abuse
 - Mother-daughter survival & silence
 - Power, corruption, and Southern legacy
 - Female-led reckoning in a male-dominated system
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MARKETABILITY

- Topical: Reflects real-world church abuse scandals and political cover-ups
 - Thrilling: Pacing mixes noir investigation with high-emotion family reveals
 - Cinematic: Southern Gothic visuals (stained glass, graveyards, gospel music)
 - Culturally specific, broadly resonant: Faith, family, justice, and identity
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TAGLINE OPTIONS

- Every resurrection begins with a death.
- The devil wears a collar.
- Some voices don't go quiet — they come back louder.